

peoplestrongⁱ



Leave Policy India

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1. Purpose

The objective of the Leave(s) Policy is to provide the employees with flexible time away options to balance their personal as well as professional life. The Leave(s) policy contains mixed type of Leave(s), suited for various requirements for our team members. This policy document provides a Leave(s) management framework for the PeopleStrong India employees.

2. Scope and applicability

This Leave(s) policy is applicable to all the Indian employees of PeopleStrong.

3. Types of Leave(s)

PeopleStrong provides the following types of Leave(s) for our team members.

1. Public Holidays
2. Privilege Leave(s)
3. Sick Leave(s)
4. Birthday & Anniversary Leave(s)
5. Childcare Leave(s)
6. Compassionate Leave(s)
7. Maternity Leave(s)
8. Paternity Leave(s)
9. Adoption Leave(s)
10. Leave(s) for commissioning mothers
11. Covid Leave(s)
12. Personal/ Sabbatical Leave(s)
13. Compensatory off

3.1 Public Holidays

PeopleStrong offers 10 Public holidays to all its Indian employees for every calendar year. A holiday calendar is uploaded at the beginning of every year on HRMS portal, which can be referred to for any upcoming public holidays.

- There are 10 fixed holidays that are applicable to all.
- There are 2 flexible holidays, which each employee can choose from the list of available holidays.
- Public holidays are applicable for all grades of employees.
- Employees on notice period can also avail the public holidays.

3.2 Privilege Leave

- **Entitlement:** Each employee is entitled to 18 days of Privilege Leave(s) during the calendar year (excluding public holidays and weekly offs)

- **Accrual:** Privileged Leave(s) is accrued at the rate of 1.5 Leave(s) per month.
- **Eligibility:** Privileged Leave(s) is applicable for all permanent employees at Grade 1 and above. Privileged Leave(s) is applicable once the employee's probation period is complete. Upon completion of probation, the privilege Leave(s) accrued during probation will also be credited to employee's Leave(s) balance.
- **Accumulation & carry forward:** Employees can carry forward a maximum number of Privileged Leave(s) from the current year to the next year as below:

Sates	Annual PL Allocation	Maximum PL Carry Forward Limit per Year	Maximum PL Balance Allowed
Karnataka	18	18	45
Maharashtra	18	18	45
Haryana	18	18	30
Others	18	18	30

Any Leave(s) over and above the maximum PL Balance allowed would lapse automatically.

- **Encashment:** During the time of separation, the employee can encash the earned privilege Leave(s) as per the maximum PL balance mentioned in the above table.
- **Availing Privilege Leave(s):** Privilege Leave(s) can be taken as half day or full day, upto the maximum of the PL Leave(s) balance; in discussion with the L1 manager, without hampering any business deliverable.

3.3 Sick Leave

Sick Leave(s) is a special benefit offered to all PeopleStrong employees (G0 and above). **Entitlement:** Each employee is entitled to 12 days of sick leave(s) during the calendar year (excluding public holidays and weekly offs).

Accrual: Sick Leave(s) is accrued at the rate of 1 Leave(s) per month. Sick Leave(s) is transferred to the Leave(s) balance of the employee at the beginning of each quarter, for the entire quarter i.e., 3 in advance. If an employee joins in the middle of the quarter the Leave(s) is added on a pro rata basis.

Sick Leave(s) cannot be encashed or adjusted against the notice period, at the time of separation. Sick Leave(s) cannot be carry forwarded from one calendar year to another. All remaining Sick Leave(s) at the end of the year are exhausted. Only 3 SL's can be applied at one go on the HRMS portal.

3.4 Birthday and Anniversary Leave

All PeopleStrong employees are entitled for the 2 special Leave(s) – Birthday and Anniversary Leave(s).

Only those employees whose marriage date is updated on HRMS portal can avail these leave(s) benefit. It can be availed on the dates mentioned on the portal and cannot be carry forwarded or used in future.

3.5 Childcare Leave

We understand the importance of managing the growing years of children, hence a special benefit of Childcare Leave(s) is offered to all PeopleStrong employees.

PeopleStrong offers 5 days of childcare Leave(s) to all those employees who have children below the age of 5 years.

- This Leave(s) can be availed once a year and cannot be taken in parts. The employee needs to have a valid childcare reason in order to utilize this benefit.
- This Leave(s) benefit needs to be approved atleast 7 days prior to the actual Leave(s) dates by informing and applying for the Leave(s) on HRMS portal.

3.6 Compassionate Leave

This Leave(s) is a grant paid time off work to employees following the death of an immediate family member. Employees are eligible for up to 7 calendar days Leave(s), if necessary, in the event of the death of an immediate family member (defined as parents, grandparents, siblings, spouse, children and in-laws).

Privilege Leave(s) can be clubbed along with compassionate Leave(s), in case more Leave(s) are required by the employee to recover from the mishap.

3.7 Maternity Leave

PeopleStrong realizes that all its women employees should cherish the experience of pre and post maternity phase, hence the exclusive benefit of maternity Leave(s) is provided to all our women colleagues.

Entitlement:

- All women employees who have worked for more than 80 days in the 12 months prior to the delivery date, are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity Leave(s) (including rest days, week offs, public holidays), of which not more than 8 weeks shall precede the expected date of delivery.
- For all women employee having two or more than two surviving children shall be entitled to avail maximum Leave(s) of 12 calendar weeks (84 days) of which not more than six weeks shall precede the date of expected delivery.

Guidelines:

- The entire duration of maternity Leave(s) is to be taken in one stretch. Women employee availing the benefit cannot take maternity Leave(s) in parts. In scenario where the employee resumes the service within/ before 26 weeks of maternity

Leave(s), the remainder weeks of maternity Leave(s) will stand expired and cannot be applied again later.

- The maternity Leave(s) benefit of 26 weeks paid Leave(s), can only be availed by the women employee for a maximum of two times during their tenure.

Application of maternity Leave(s):

- The employee shall inform respective L1 manager, at least one month in advance and apply the said Leave(s) on HRMS portal. This shall be accompanied by a certificate from the ESIC Hospital / a gynecologist, specifying the expected date of delivery.
- The above point can be an exception for the employees who have medical advice to be on Leave(s) in case of emergency where the employee may choose to avail Leave(s) from the current Leave(s) balance instead of applying Leave(s) Without Pay.
- In case of demise of the woman employee during the period of pregnancy or childbirth, PeopleStrong is liable to payment till day of her death and unutilized privilege Leave(s). The computation for the same shall be (Annual payroll salary/12/30) *number of days of unutilized Maternity Leave(s).

Additional Benefit: Maternity Medical Leave(s):

- This Leave(s) for women employees who are suffering from illness arising out of pregnancy, delivery, premature birth of a child, medical termination of pregnancy or Tubectomy operation and can be availed before or after maternity Leave(s). (Based on The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961.) This needs to be approved by the L1 manager and the HR. At the expiry of the maternity Leave(s) period, if the company doctors or a registered medical officer certifies the employee as unfit for duty, her absence shall be treated as medical Leave(s) at the discretion of the L1 manager and HR Head.
- The employees can avail 4 weeks of Leave(s) under the maternity medical Leave(s).
- Any Leave(s) beyond such period will be subject to existing Leave(s) balance and prior approval from L1 Manager and HR Head. In case of unavailability of any such Leave(s) balance, the employee may apply for Leave(s) Without Pay.
- The employee needs to mandatorily produce the medical certificate to avail this benefit.

Extension of Maternity Leave(s):

The employee can avail the Maternity LWP within the first year of childbirth after all her Leave(s) under ML and all the PL are exhausted.

- If an employee availing Maternity Leave(s) feels the need to extend the period of her absence beyond 26 weeks, Leave(s) Without Pay (LWP) for a maximum period of 2 month may be availed post approval from the L1 Manager, L2 Manager & HR.
- Employee is required to apply for such extension on HRMS portal under the category of 'LWP'.

Return to work after Leave(s): On resuming back to work post the Leave(s), the employee

will be absorbed back in the Organization. PeopleStrong will make best efforts to place the employees either in the same role/profile or in the available role that matches employee's competency profile. Every effort will be made to make the resumption to work process as smooth as possible.

Leave(s) for Miscarriage:

In the unfortunate event of a miscarriage during pregnancy, Leave(s) shall be granted in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act / ESI Act to female employees.

Leave(s) Duration: Leave(s) are allowed for a maximum of 6 weeks (42 days) following the day of miscarriage. The definition of 'week' is as per the Maternity Benefit Act and includes weekly offs and public holidays (if any). The employee availing this Leave(s) shall notify their L1 manager or HR team as early as possible.

Employee can also suffix their privilege Leave(s) balance and in case if more Leave(s) are required can apply for the LWP on HRMS portal as per the standard system.

3.8 Paternity Leave

All PeopleStrong male employees are eligible for paternity Leave(s) benefits.

Leave(s) Duration: Continuous Leave(s) of 10 calendar days to be availed within three months from the child's birth / adoption date.

In case of Adoption, supporting documents required:

- Adoption Deed
- Birth certificate of the child
- Any other legal document that validates the adoption process

Frequency of Leave(s): All male employees may avail of Paternity Leave(s) for the first two children.

Application for Leave(s): The employee shall notify the L1 manager atleast 7 days in advance.

In case of any unfortunate situation where the spouse of the employee passed away during child birth, the employee would then receive 26 calendar weeks of paid paternity Leave(s).

3.9 LGBTQ Parental Leave

All LGBTQ employees or 3rd gender employees will be eligible for parental Leave(s) in case of adoption or surrogacy.

Leave(s) Duration: Continuous Leave(s) of 26 weeks can be availed by the employee. The Leave(s) are to be availed from the date the child is handed over.

Please note LGBTQ Parental Leave(s) can be availed only after the supporting documents are submitted as mentioned below:

- Adoption deed
- Birth certificate of child
- Any other legal document that validates the adoption process

3.10 Adoption Leave

All female employees who legally adopt a child (no age limit), shall be entitled to Leave(s) as per the guidelines specified below.

Leave(s) Duration: Continuous Leave(s) of 26 calendar weeks can be availed by the employee. The Leave(s) are to be availed from the date the child is handed over to the adopting mother.

Please note adoption Leave(s) can be availed only after the supporting documents are submitted as mentioned below:

- Adoption deed
- Birth certificate of child
- Any other legal document that validates the adoption process

3.11 Leave for Commissioning and Surrogate mothers

A commissioning mother, i.e., those female employees who are biological mothers and wish to have a child and prefer to get embryo implanted in another woman shall be entitled to Leave(s) as per the guidelines specified below.

Leave(s) Duration: Leave(s) allowed shall be for a maximum of 26 calendar weeks from the date the child is handed over to the commissioning mother.

For all female employee having two or more than two surviving children shall be entitled to avail maximum Leave(s) of 12 calendar weeks (84 days) from the date the child is handed over to the commissioning mother.

A surrogate mother, i.e., those female employees who bears a child on behalf of another woman either from her own egg fertilized by the other woman's partner or from the implantation in her uterus of a fertilized egg from the other woman would have the same benefits as prescribed for maternity Leave(s) admissible to a woman employee who conceives and carries the child.

3.12 Covid Leave

Safeguarding the wellness of our team members during the ongoing pandemic, all employees are eligible for Covid Leave(s) for upto 7 calendar days. The covid Leave(s) has to be availed at a stretch and can be availed only for the following reasons:

- Employee is diagnosed with COVID-19, with a positive Covid test report.
- Employees who are caring for a spouse, child or parent who are sick with COVID.

The L1 manager of the employee availing the covid Leave(s) needs to be informed within the first 5 days of covid positive report.

3.13 Compensatory off

A compensatory off is only applicable when working on a public holiday or on a weekly off (as per the project roaster).

- Employee can accumulate maximum of 2 days of Compensatory Leave(s) at any given point in time.
- It is only valid for 30 days from the date of working on a public holiday/weekly off. Compensatory off is lapsed after 30 days.
- Compensatory Off Leave(s) (CO) is non – encashable.
- Compensatory off (s) cannot be adjusted against notice period.

3.14 Personal/ Sabbatical Leave

This additional benefit is designed to give employees the opportunity to have a break from their role and work for a predetermined time period for various reasons.

Eligibility: Only the employees who have spent more than 2 years in the organization, can avail the sabbatical Leave(s) benefits

Leave(s) Duration: Employees can avail a sabbatical for a maximum of 90 calendar days.

Guidelines:

- All sabbatical needs to be approved by the HR head, Practice head and function head atleast 1 month prior to the sabbatical start date.
- No salary will be paid during the sabbatical period.
- No PF, Pension, Gratuity will be paid during the sabbatical Leave(s) period.
- However, the period during which the employee is on sabbatical will be considered for calculating the minimum required service for eligibility for Gratuity (4 years and 190 working days) and Pension (5 years), provided the employee rejoins the company immediately after the sabbatical.
- In case the employee fails to join the company after availing the sabbatical Leave(s), the last working day prior to the sabbatical start date would be considered for all relieving formalities.
- Employee is required to exhaust their annual Leave(s) balance prior to applying for sabbatical Leave(s)
- In case employee applies for sabbatical Leave(s) for next calendar year and even though it gets approved, if the Leave(s) applied for is outside the rules/ guidelines of the policy as per the employee's year end Leave(s) balance, it may be cancelled
- On approval of sabbatical Leave(s), employee will need to obtain no due clearance from the concerned departments. On the last working day, employee will need to hand over the laptop, ID card or any other company asset to the admin department.
- If the employee has availed any company loan/ advance, then it needs to be settled in full before going on the sabbatical Leave(s).
- In case the employee resigns during or after the sabbatical period he will need to complete the formalities as per the Employee separation process.
- On return from sabbatical the employee must inform the HR team by emailing at yourhr@peoplestrong.com, who will follow the required formalities for

commencement of employee's payroll.

3.15 Leave Without Pay

- In case employee opts for Leave(s) without pay, sandwich Leave(s) rule will be applicable. This means the Leave(s) will be treated as continuous. For example, if an employee takes Leave(s) without pay on Friday and Monday and in between there are two weekly offs i.e., Saturday and Sunday, then 2 days coming in between Friday and Monday will also be counted as Leave(s) without pay and total Leave(s) will be 4. This also includes any holidays falling in between the Leave(s) without dates. If employee takes Leave(s) without pay from Monday to Friday and resumes work on next Monday, total Leave(s) without pay will be counted as 7.

4. Procedure to apply for Leave

All employees can login to HRMS portal – mobile or app, to see all the Leave(s) that are applicable for them. The real time Leave(s) balance, leave(s) credit and usage can also be seen easily. Following are the steps that can be followed to apply and view Leave(s):

1. Log in to your HRMS portal
2. Click on "Leave(s)"
3. Click on "My Leave(s) Details"
4. Click on "New Leave(s)"
5. Submit your Leave(s) request (with attachment also) and get it approved by your L1 Manager.

5. General guidelines

1. All Leave(s) should necessarily have prior approval of the Reporting authority/ Function Head.
2. Any Leave(s) taken without prior approval (unplanned Leave(s)) or if Leave(s) taken is not regularized, post facto, it will be treated as Leave(s) without Pay. Regularization of Leave(s) post facto is subject to approval by Line Managers and Function Head. If Leave(s) is disapproved, it will be treated as Leave(s) without Pay. Leave(s) taken without prior approval could also attract disciplinary action.
3. Unplanned Leave(s) are those Leave(s) which are taken on emergencies, sickness, death or any other critical situation where the employee is not able to submit the Leave(s) application. The employee must inform the company & concerned head before 9.30 AM on that day for unplanned Leave(s). The unplanned Leave(s) is limited to 1 Leave(s) in a month. In case there is no information, this Leave(s) will be considered as Leave(s) without pay on discretion of the immediate supervisor. Any adherence to this policy can lead to disciplinary action.
4. Leave(s) must be planned sufficiently in advance (except during exigencies), such

that it does not affect the day-to-day work. Employees are recommended to plan their Leave(s) at least one month in advance and share it with their respective L1. HR can disapprove any approved Leave(s) if deemed as inappropriate as per the Leave(s) policy.

5. The entitlement for the number of Leave(s) available to an employee will be prorated, rounded off to the nearest full day, based on the date the employee joins the organization during a calendar year.
6. Holidays intervening between Leave(s) will not be construed as Leave(s) unless it is Leave(s) without pay. Leave(s) shall commence from the sanctioned start date and shall end on the sanctioned end date.
7. During notice period, only Birthday Leave and compassionate leave can be applied on HRMS portal.

6. Leave(s) Summary

Type Of Leave	Number	Days/Weeks
Public Holidays	10	Days
Privilege Leave	18	Days
Sick Leave	12	Days
Birthday Leave	1	Days
Anniversary Leave	1	Days
Childcare Leave	5	Days
Compassionate Leave	7	Days
Maternity Leave	26	Weeks
LGBTQ Paternal Leave	26	Weeks
Paternity	10	Days
Adoption Leave	26	Weeks
Leave for Commissioning and Surrogate mothers	12	Weeks
Covid Leave	7	Days
Compensatory off	2	Days
Personal/ Sabbatical Leave	90	Days